

How My Portfolio Navigation Works

One part of my portfolio that I wanted to understand better was how the navigation connects the different parts of the site. I structured my portfolio around three main areas: Home, Work, and About/Contact. Home introduces me and previews my work, Work contains my security case studies, and About/Contact contains my background and professional links.

The basic idea is simpler than I first thought. A navigation link is basically a way of telling the website which part of the site I want to open. When I click something like “Work,” the site uses that link to take me to the Work page instead of making me manually find the page or reload the whole project myself.

I chose Next.js with TypeScript for the portfolio. One reason was that I wanted the site to have a reusable structure instead of building every page completely separately. My case studies also need a consistent structure, such as Scope, Method, Findings, and Impact. That means the portfolio can keep the same overall layout while the actual content changes from project to project.

What I understand now is that the navigation is not the thing that creates the pages. It is more like the connection between the pages. The page structure and the navigation work together: the pages provide the content, while the navigation gives the visitor a clear way to move between them.

I also learned why planning the sitemap before building matters. Without a clear structure, I could end up with pages and links that do not have an obvious relationship. By deciding on Home, Work, and About/Contact first, I had a simple structure to build around.

So, in my own words, the navigation is basically the road system of my portfolio. The pages are the destinations, and the navigation gives the user the roads between them. It sounds obvious now, but understanding that relationship makes the structure of the site much easier for me to reason about.